

Prior Authorization Request - Inpatient Admission

Member: Linda Ramirez DOB: 1953-07-02 (age 73) Member ID: MBR-0101

Requesting facility: Lakeside Regional Hospital, Utilization Review Dept.

Requested service: Elective inpatient admission, open lumbar spinal fusion, L4-L5

CPT 22612. Planned admit date: 2026-10-13.

Level of care requested: INPATIENT.

Surgeon Operative Plan

Diagnosis: degenerative spondylolisthesis L4-L5 with neurogenic claudication.

Plan: open L4-L5 decompression and posterolateral fusion with instrumentation.

Expected length of stay: 3 midnights for pain control, mobilization and monitoring.

Shared decision making completed with patient and daughter; risks and benefits reviewed.

Imaging and Conservative Care

Flexion-extension radiographs show 5 mm anterolisthesis at L4-L5 with dynamic instability.

MRI shows severe central canal stenosis at L4-L5.

Failed 9 months of conservative care: physical therapy, NSAIDs, and two epidural steroid injections.

History and Physical

Past medical history: heart failure (EF 35 percent), COPD on home oxygen, type 2 diabetes.

Post-operative plan: telemetry monitoring, respiratory therapy and cardiology co-management.